[LIT-FLK-017] Har eina Ngaprum wui Khararchan

Translation: The Fable of the Mountain Hen and the River Eel

Work Type: FOLK_TALE | Creator: Tangkhul Oral Tradition Custodians | Year: 1982
Village: Ukhrul | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: BK-CIIL-003
Publisher / Source: Central Institute of Indian Languages, Mysore
Clearance: Academic Documentation | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Inter-species treaty and customary disaster preparedness (*Ram-Ngaran*), Etiological fable explaining avian and aquatic behavior during

Structure & Meter: Ancestral prose fable incorporating poetic dialogue couplets and envir

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Critical Overview: Preserved in the CIIL folklore corpus, this fable
illustrates the deep ecological awareness of traditional Tangkhul society,

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Khararchan-wui thotharan ram-ngaleili kazing mashun kachiphun eina tuikh
Kaphung wui meiphor har eina kongrei wui ngaprum akha, kaphung mayon-kac
’Kazing-mik kashungli kaphung ngalei lungkui kachiva ngasamphang-khavai,
Harna kaphung-wui won theida, ’Kongrei-li tui-ngaprum kapam eina kongkas
Ngaprumna kongkhur kazat eina kaphung lung-ngakui rathuk-laga, harna kaz
Ani leikashi eina ngaran-kazat wui vangli, tuikharor kachiva-li kaphung

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

In ancestral epochs of great summer downpours, mountain torrents flooded
At that hour, a wise red jungle fowl and a sleek mountain river eel met
’When torrents rage, let mountain birds sound the warning alarm, and riv
The fowl watched from the tall oak branches, while the swift eel navigat
When the deluge threatened to submerge the low pasture terraces, the fow
Through their sacred covenant and mutual vigilance, both sky fliers and

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Ngaprum : Mountain freshwater eel, inhabiting clean upland r
* Tuikharor : Monsoon floodwaters, overflowing riverbanks and ra
* Meiphor har : Red jungle fowl (Gallus gallus), native mountain w

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